



Humanoid
Robot Club

StarkHacks

HARDWARE HACKATHON

April 17 - April 19, 2026
Purdue University

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general info.

Thank you for sponsoring the hackathon. As the event approaches, we're incredibly excited to move forward and wanted to share this document as a comprehensive overview of everything you'll need to know and prepare for.

Here are a few key details about the event:

- We've received **2,500+ applications from 65+ countries and 300+ universities worldwide**, including top institutions such as University of California Berkeley, Stanford University, University of Waterloo, California Institute of Technology, etc.
- From this pool, we will be **selecting 1,000+** of the strongest applicants to attend in person.
- The primary venue will be the Purdue Armory. Due to overwhelming interest, we will also utilize CL50 to accommodate any participant overflow.
- All meals will be served in Lawson. Participants will be assigned designated meal windows. Sponsors, judges, and mentors will receive priority access before general participant meal service begins.

Design Week

Unlike software hackathons where projects can often be built entirely within 36 hours, high-quality hardware projects require additional planning and design time. To support this, we will host a Design Week from April 10 – April 17, during which participants may begin CAD modeling and electrical design.

Participants are not permitted to bring any pre-built physical components to the hackathon. However, they may:

- Submit files in advance for 3D printing
- Reserve basic components required for their builds

Additionally, sponsors are welcome and encouraged to host online technical workshops during Design Week. As students begin developing their ideas, these sessions can help them better understand your tools, APIs, hardware platforms, or challenge statements. We recommend keeping these workshops foundational and beginner-friendly to properly prepare participants before the in-person hacking begins.

travel to purdue.

Air Travel

1. Purdue University Airport (LAF): Located on campus, offers daily service to and from Chicago O'Hare
2. Indianapolis International Airport (IND): 65 miles south of West Lafayette (takes 1.5 - 2 hours)
3. Chicago O'Hare International Airport (ORD): 140 miles north of West Lafayette (takes 2.5 - 3 hours)
4. Chicago Midway International Airport (MDW): 130 miles north of West Lafayette (takes 2.5 - 3 hours)

Please note that Purdue University is located in Eastern Time (EST) and Chicago is located in Central Time (CST).

We recommend flying to IND or ORD and then taking a shuttle to Purdue. LAF is a convenient option but will likely be more expensive.

Parking

For on-campus parking instructions, please see: [Visitor Parking - West Lafayette, IN](#)

Ground Travel

1. Amtrak
2. Greyhound
3. FlixBus

These services are available to the local area, stopping at a station in downtown Lafayette. Visitors can ride Greater Lafayette's CityBus system or hop on a rideshare service to Purdue (about 1.5 miles away).

Airport Shuttle Services

1. Lafayette Limo
2. Reindeer Shuttle

Both operate scheduled services to/from IND and ORD to Purdue's campus. We recommend booking in advance.

Uber and Lyft rideshares are available, but there can be long wait times from ORD/IND due to the distance of the journey.

We recommend either taking a shuttle or driving to Purdue.

Lodging Near Purdue

Sponsors would be responsible for booking their own accommodations. Popular options include:

1. West Lafayette

- a. Hilton Garden Inn West Lafayette: [Hilton Garden Inn Hotel in West Lafayette, Indiana](#)
- b. Hampton Inn & Suites West Lafayette: [Hampton Inn and Suites by Hilton West Lafayette, IN Hotel](#)

2. Lafayette (5-10 minute drive)

- a. Courtyard by Marriott Lafayette: [Hotels in Lafayette, Indiana | Courtyard Lafayette](#)
- b. DoubleTree by Hilton Lafayette East: [DoubleTree by Hilton Lafayette East Hotel](#)

Rooms fill quickly during large campus events, so early booking is recommended.

setup-teardown.

Check In

Location: Sponsor Check-In Desk at Purdue Armory

Address: 812 3rd Street, West Lafayette, IN 47907 (on the drill floor)

Time: Friday, April 17, from 3.00 PM

- Sponsor badges will be handed out at check-in. All sponsors are required to wear their sponsor badge at all times while on-site. Failure to display the badge may result in removal from the premises.
- All attendees must present a valid, unexpired, government-issued photo ID that includes their name and date of birth. The ID must be in English (e.g., U.S. driver's license, state ID, or foreign passport).
- Unacceptable forms of identification include foreign national ID cards, corporate badges, or any non-government-issued identification.

Please note: All booth setup, staffing, and teardown are the responsibility of the sponsor. It is unlikely that our team will be available to assist, as we will be managing multiple operational areas throughout the event.

Setup

- Setup may begin immediately after you check in.
- Each booth includes: one 6 ft x 2 ft table, 2 chairs, and 2 power outlets.
- A standard tablecloth will be provided; you are welcome to bring a custom tablecloth or branded materials.
- You may bring banners and additional branding elements. Please inform us in advance if any display is oversized.
- All booth setup is your responsibility.
- Booths may not open to participants before 8:00 PM.
- A dedicated seating area will be available for sponsors during the opening ceremony. Please use that space until the booths open at 8:00 PM.

During the Hackathon

- Booths may be used for recruiting, technical mentorship, or sharing general company information.
- Booths must be fully staffed by your team.
- We strongly recommend staffing your booth Friday evening and for the majority of Saturday.
- Overnight staffing is optional.

Teardown

All materials must be cleared and the booth fully vacated by 8:00 AM on Sunday.

the ceremonies.

Opening Ceremony

Location: Purdue Armory

Address: 812 3rd Street, West Lafayette, IN 47907

Time: Friday, April 17, from 6:00 PM - 7:30 PM

What to Expect:

- Welcome remarks
- Sponsor presentations
- Rules, judging criteria, and schedule overview

Please note that booths must remain closed until 8:00 PM. All sponsor representatives must be in the dedicated seating area until the opening ceremony ends.

Platinum Sponsors:

- 2-minute keynote (strict time limit; hard stop enforced)
- Co-host and presenting sponsors get 5 minutes
- Slides must be submitted by March 31
- Use this keynote to briefly introduce your company, outline your sponsor track and prize, highlight any free resources or perks you're offering, and explain why participants should visit your booth.

Closing Ceremony

Location: PMU North and South Ballrooms

Address: 101 Grant St, West Lafayette, IN 47906 (1st Floor)

Time: Friday, April 19, from 1:00 PM - 4:00 PM

What to Expect:

- Address by the keynote speakers
- Sponsor challenge winners
- Final awards and closing remarks

Sponsor Tracks:

- Sponsors will be invited on stage to present their prizes
- Stage time is limited to prize distribution only
- No speeches or additional remarks from winners or sponsor representatives will be permitted

Winners Mixer

Location: PMU North and South Ballrooms

Time: Friday, April 19, from 5:00 PM - 7:00 PM

What to Expect:

- Networking with hackathon winners and organizers
- Light refreshments provided

food and snacks.

Meals

- All meals during the hackathon will be provided at no cost to participants, mentors, and sponsors.
- We will accommodate dietary restrictions; please ensure they are communicated in advance.
- The first hour of each meal service will be exclusive to mentors and sponsors.

Meal Schedule (Subject to Change):

- Friday Dinner: 8:00 PM – 11:00 PM
- Saturday Breakfast: 6:00 AM – 9:00 AM
- Saturday Lunch: 12:00 PM – 3:00 PM
- Saturday Dinner: 6:00 PM – 9:00 PM
- Sunday Brunch: 9:00 AM – 12:00 PM

Location: Lawson Computer Science Building, 305 N University St, West Lafayette, IN 47907

Snacks & Beverages

- A snack booth will be open starting Friday at 8:00 PM and will remain accessible 24/7 throughout the event.
- Assorted snacks, energy & soft drinks will be available.

workshops.

Physical Workshops

- All workshop details must be submitted by March 15.
- Workshops must be fully staffed and conducted by you.
- All materials and equipment must be provided by you.
- Seating capacity options: approximately 40–50 participants or up to 100 participants. Final room allocation will depend on student interest sign-ups.
- Location: Lawson Computer Science Building, 305 N University St, West Lafayette, IN 47907
- Timing Options: Friday evening or Saturday afternoon.
- Duration: 30-minute or 1-hour slots.
- Limit of one physical workshop per sponsor.

Online Workshops

- Technical workshops are strongly recommended during Design Week (April 10 - April 17) to maximize engagement.
- Sessions may also be scheduled earlier, if preferred.

Please choose your preferred workshop slot here:

<https://starkhacks.com/sponsor-workshops>

tracks & judging.

Track Selection

- Participants select sponsor tracks at the time of project submission.
- Please select a track here:
<https://starkhacks.com/sponsor-tracks>
- If you have a custom track, please confirm it with your assigned POC beforehand.

Track Types - Broad Tracks

Broad tracks typically attract more diverse and higher submission volumes. Example broad tracks:

1. Smart Home - project examples: adaptive HVAC controller with occupancy detection, RFID-based smart pantry inventory tracker, fall-detection floor sensor grid
2. Automation - project examples: autonomous indoor delivery robot, vision-based automated sorting system, real-time defect detection camera
3. Sustainability - project examples: vision-based smart waste segregation bin, hardware-metered dorm energy dashboard, adaptive daylight-responsive lighting system

Broad themes encourage creativity, variety, and larger submission pools.

Track Types - Narrow / Specific Tracks

Examples:

- Advanced gripper mechanisms
- Robots built for a single defined task
- Highly specific technical challenges

While focused tracks can be impactful, they typically result in fewer submissions and more similar project outcomes.

Available Track Categories:

- We have compiled a list of potential sponsor tracks for the hackathon. All Gold and Platinum sponsors are invited to select one track from the list to be associated with your company.
- When selecting your track, please enter your name in the third column labeled “Sponsor Rep Name” so we can identify who reserved the track and provide assistance if any conflicts arise.
- Kindly ensure your track is selected by March 15 (or as soon as possible).
- **Link:** <https://starkhacks.com/sponsor-tracks>

Submission volume will depend heavily on how accessible the track is to build for, as well as the attractiveness of the prize. Narrower tracks generally receive fewer submissions.

Judging

- Sponsors are responsible for judging their own track.
- A judging rubric must be submitted to us by March 31 for review. Please add this to the track selection sheet.
- You will be provided with the list of teams and table numbers that submitted to your track.
- Judging must be completed by 10:00 AM on Sunday.
- If additional time is required, final evaluations may be completed on Devpost. Judging timelines cannot be extended beyond the designated deadline.

Prizes

- Sponsors are responsible for procuring their own prizes.
- Prizes may either be shipped to the venue in advance or brought on-site.
- Please confirm prize details with us by March 15.
- We strongly encourage prizes that are unique, hardware-focused, and exciting for builders, rather than defaulting to overly mainstream options. Consider items such as Meta Ray-Ban smart glasses, Oura Rings, Omi wearables, 3D printing pens or compact 3D printers, fitness bands like Whoop, or high-value tech such as Apple products (iPhone, iPad, MacBook), depending on brand alignment.
- Please add your prizes to the track selection sheet.

the deadlines.

RSVP form - <u>https://starkhacks.com/sponsors-rsvp</u> Everyone who is coming in person must fill this form out.	March 15
Detailed Workshop Information	March 15
If you wish to give extra hardware through our hardware booth, please let us know.	March 15
Tracks + Awards Info	March 15
If you wish to give extra merch through our channels, please let us know.	March 31
All physical in-kind material shipped to us	March 31

If you join us as a sponsor after March 15, please share all the details within 2 weeks of finalizing the sponsorship.

contact us.

For any questions, please reach out to your PoC within your existing email thread. You may also contact:

- Riddhi Gupta (President) – gupta989@purdue.edu
- Aayan Agarwal (Treasurer) – agarw357@purdue.edu

Day-of-Event Support

1. A separate on-site Sponsorship Team will be available to assist you throughout the event. Their names and contact details will be shared closer to the event date.
2. Our team is highly active on Discord. Once you join, you may post any questions or concerns in the designated sponsor channels for a quick response.
3. If you need immediate assistance, please contact:
sponsor-help@starkhacks.com

Shipping Instructions

Please send all shipments to:

128 Memorial Mall Dr, RM G65 West Lafayette, IN 47907

The package must include the following ATTN line:

Aayan Agarwal (StarkHacks Prizes / In-Kind / [Purpose])